

It's Your Choice

The Palm Portable Keyboard and the GoType! Pro keyboard have a lot in common. Neither of them require extra cables and the organiser can be docked into the integrated connector available on the keyboard. They don't need a separate adapter for power; they consume a bit of the device's power. But they do have some distinct features.

The GoType! Pro keyboard has an integrated power charger, using which you can charge your Palm using the Palm V AC adapter.

This keyboard has a built-in serial port, which enables you to directly sync your

PDA with your desktop without the need for an additional HotSync cradle. This device doesn't work with Palm m500 and m505. GoType! Pro has six programmable keys which can access or launch applications or programs at one touch.

The Palm Portable Keyboard, slightly bigger than your organiser, is foldable and actually fits into your pocket. It has nine programmable keys to launch or access applications you frequently use. This keyboard expands to the size of a desktop keyboard and the keys are depressed when it's folded, which makes for its miniature size. The key spacing is 19 mm



horizontally and vertically—the same as in desktop keyboards.

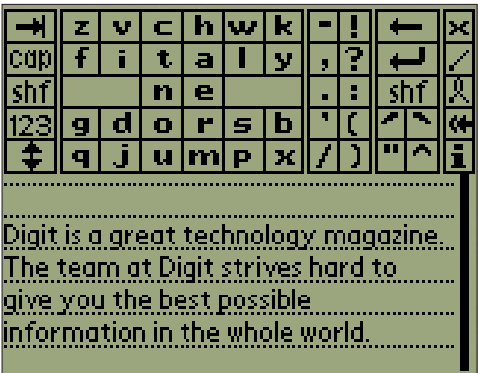
As for the prices of the two keyboards, the GoType! Pro keyboard is priced at \$70 (approx Rs 3,220) whereas the Palm Portable Keyboard is priced at \$99 (approx Rs 4,554). Take your pick!

What about a Hardware Keyboard?

Although software keyboards are useful, if you are accustomed to the more tangible variety, you will obviously prefer something similar. Though Graffiti is good enough for entering brief notes and entries, it does not match the speed and comfort of a hardware keyboard.

The problem with software input methods is that you would be more often concentrating on how you are writing, rather than on what you are writing.

So if you feel better with a keyboard you can actually get your hands on, then here's some welcome news for you—the Palm can use a hardware keyboard. These neat little foldable keyboards can actually fit into your pocket. They can be plugged into the synching socket and used to input data into the device. What's more, you can concentrate on what you are writing rather than how you are writing. Keyboards also come to your rescue when you want to type in something quickly.



The Fitaly keyboard can be moved anywhere on the screen

with it while typing as it adjusts and repositions itself upon encountering a text entry on a line very close to it, thus letting you review what you have typed. It also has four accent modifiers that enable you to switch to the non-ASCII set of characters defined by ANSI (American National Standards Institute)—acute, grave, circumflex and umlaut. A tap on an accent changes the keyboard appearance and switches to that particular set.

TealScript your life

Those of you who claim to be die-hard Graffiti fans might now find your loyalty being severely tested. Although Graffiti can be fun to learn in the beginning, it can turn out to be slow going when you realise your Palm has an attitude to match yours—it refuses to recognise some of your strokes. You have to be perfect the way you draw a 'u' or a 'v', and especially the way you draw characters such as 'g' or 'k' that involve more strokes.

Life is not smooth sailing with Graffiti. So would it not be convenient if you could make your Palm learn your style of writing, instead of

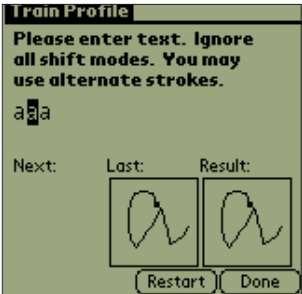
you learning what the computer understands? If your answer is yes, then you can look towards TealScript as the solution you were in search of. TealScript lets you train your Palm to understand the way you write different characters. You can make separate entries for every letter and symbol. Once you have trained the Palm to recognise your style of writing you can use the trained script in the Graffiti area to enter your information. You can make additional entries and even retrain the Palm for a particular letter or symbol.

If you find typing a chore and yearn for an easy solution, then maybe LookDA can be of assistance. Here, according to your convenience, you could choose to install a small or even a large dictionary and then make entries into or delete them from the dictionary.

The next time you start typing, the word list automatically pops up and you simply have to tap on the word in the list and the prompter completes the word for you. If the word displayed in the list is not the one you want, you could set the pop-up list to show all the possible words that start with the letters you've entered. The software shows a preview of the possible word on the top left corner of the screen.

Special case

If your data input involves the use of many special characters such as fractions, the copyright



You can train your Palm to your style of writing using TealScript